project.org

STUDENT HANDOUT

GREEN LEVEL
MORE SUPPORT

Seeing Through Deception

Grades 6–8 · Library

ADMIT ONE

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

The SIFT method. Professional fact-checkers use these four steps to verify information. You can too!

S STOP	I INVESTIGATE	F FIND	T TRACE
Pause before you react or share	Who created this? What's their reputation?	Can you find this claim covered elsewhere?	Where did this information originally come from?

PRACTICE 1

Evaluate this source

Source: A social media post says "Scientists announce chocolate cures all diseases!" with a link to a website called "HealthNewsToday.net" you've never heard of.

SIFT STEP	YOUR ANSWER
S – STOP: What's your first reaction? Write it, then pause.	
I – INVESTIGATE: What would you search to learn about this source?	
F – FIND: Where could you look for other coverage of this claim?	
T – TRACE: What original source would need to exist for this to be true?	

Your verdict: RELIABLE / UNRELIABLE / NEED MORE INFO

PRACTICE 2

Evaluate another source

Source: An article from your local newspaper's website about a new school policy, with the reporter's name and contact information included.

SIFT STEP	YOUR ANSWER
S – STOP: What's your first reaction?	
I – INVESTIGATE: What do you know about this source?	
F – FIND: Could you verify this elsewhere?	

Your verdict: RELIABLE / UNRELIABLE / NEED MORE INFO

MINI MUSEUM CONNECTION

Spirit photographers in the 1860s exploited people who didn't know photos could be faked. Today, many don't know videos can be faked (deepfakes). The lesson: always verify before you trust!

minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving/illusions

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Teach someone in your family the SIFT method. Practice it together on something you see online.